

Sarita Ross Interview Guide: Docket Clerk

Background and Introduction

Introduce self

Provide description of purpose of interview.

- We are interested in learning more about your processes around some specific features.

Request permission to **record** and provide assurance.

- The recording is used only for note-taking and is deleted at the end of the project. Participation in this interview is completely voluntary and optional, you can terminate the session at any time for any reason. Your responses are confidential, when the findings are reported they will be aggregated so that nothing that is said can be tied directly to you. You may still participate even if you opt out of session recording.

Please tell me a little about yourself and the work you do at the Tax Court.

- [probe] What are the key tasks that you perform?

Changes since they started working remote

Adding and Removing Petitioners

Tell us about an instance where there might be more than one petitioner on a case.

- Are there instances where you need to make edits to a case with more than one petitioner?
 - Can you explain why?
 - How?
- [Probe]: Do they need to be treated separately or as a group?

Tell us about an instance where a petitioner would need to be added to a case. Do you typically have everything you need to do this? If not, why?

- What are some edge cases where this is not straightforward to do? How do you handle it?
- How is this tracked/logged?
- Is there a scenario where this would need to be retrieved?

Tell us about an instance where a petitioner would need to be removed from a case. Do you typically have everything you need to do this? If not, why?

- What are some edge cases where this is not straightforward to do? How do you handle it?
- How is this tracked/logged?

- Is there a scenario where this would need to be retrieved?

In an ideal scenario, how would you do this more efficiently?

Editing Petitioner Contact Information

How do you handle changing contact information when there is more than one petitioner on the case?

Tell us about an instance where you would need to change contact information when there is more than one petitioner on the case. Do you typically have everything you need to do this? If not, why?

- What are some edge cases where this is not straightforward to do? How do you handle it?
- How is this tracked/logged?
- Is there a scenario where this would need to be retrieved?

Minute Sheets

What are minute sheets used for? Can you tell us how you specifically use them in your process?

- [probe] How do you expect the minute sheet docket entry to appear on the docket record?

NOTES:

Sarita

Docket clerk

- We do a lot, a whole lot
- Processing documents, data entry
- Work with judges, CA
- Anything that's processed is done based on tax court procedures
 - A lot of changes with the remote work

Daily activities

- Go to QC to see what's there
- See's high priority - exclamation point
- Go to Inbox and process whatever document was high priority
 - Processes Orders, Minutes, motions
 - Looks at documents - do the dates add up, year, dates are correct, language is correct
 - They add the entry - add language from the Order (not all the language but some of it)
 - Then serve on parties
- Changes with remote work + new system
 - service of document - one clerk is designated to do the paper service
 - Electronic service -
 - if They are working on the weekends or later on the weekdays - they can't serve it
 - In old system they could future date the service - they miss that feature

Multiple petitioners

- Husband and wife
 - Wife filed petition and husband has to be notified
 - Husband can come into the case or not
 - If they come into the case - they can fix Notice of Intervention
 - Docket adds to case - wife could be electronic service, but the husband would be paper service

Adding petitioner to case

- Recently got notice of intervention and couldn't add the person to case because of something in DAWSON
- Now any documents being served has to say there is an intervenor that needs paper service
 - This used to be visible in the notes - Notes would pop up when you go to case
 - Don't even pay attention to notes- doesn't even see if notes are there
- Ideal situation
 - There's nowhere that says Intervenor - somewhere where we can add this person
 - Petitioner filed the Petition ; intervenor is on the Notice but isn't on the Petition
 - Petitioner and intervenor are treated the same, both get service, treated as individuals

Notes

- Notes are used when someone at the court (ADC) is waiting for something
- If we could see that the intervenor is on the case, we would know that before processing documents
- Used for special situations
 - Petitioner is difficult - "send phone calls to ADC"
 - Frequently encounter these special cases

Service

- If husband and wife with same address and primary has e-service, secondary has paper - they aren't even serving the paper party
- If they have a different address , then they serve the paper party

Minute sheets

- Used to add a lot of information - new system is way easier
- Shows what happened at the session
- Compare Minute Sheet with any Orders they get
- Streamlines the information on the docket entry - it's all uniform now

Overall impression

- At first, clicking around a lot to get to one place
- Makes things a lot easier but in some ways makes it more difficult
- Consolidated cases - she has a bunch of consolidated cases
 - Have to file in each case
- Statistics - takes a lot to get there
- When QCing documents, if she wants to go look in the case has to go look at the case. And then click back into the case

QC process

- Not sorted in the order of the trial session date in Inbox
 - Wants to take care of the highest priority - the next trial session